

had spoken to the King, saying, The hand of our God is vpon all them that seke him, in goodnes, but his power and his wrath is against all them that forsake him.

23 So we fasted, and besoght our God for this: and he was intreated of vs.

24 Then I separated twelue of the chief of the Priests, Sherebiáh, and Hahabiáh, and ten of their brethren with them,

25 And weighed the siluer & the golde, & the vessels, *even* the offering of the house of our God, *which* the King and his counsellers, and his princes, and all Israël that were present had offred.

26 And I weighed vnto their hand six hundred and fifty ^b talents of siluer, and in siluer vessel, an hundred talents, and in golde, an hundred talents:

27 And twentie basins of golde, of a thousand ⁱ drammes, and two vessels of shining brasle very good, and precious as golde.

28 ¶ And I said vnto the, Ye are consecrate vnto the Lord, and the vessels are consecrate, and the golde and the siluer are freely offred vnto the Lord God of your fathers.

29 Watche ye, & kepe them until ye weigh them before the chief Priests and the Leuites, and the chief fathers of Israël in Ierusalém in the chambers of the house of the Lord.

30 So the Priests and the Leuites receiued the weight of the siluer and of the golde, and of the vessels to bring them to Ierusalém, vnto the house of our God.

31 ¶ Then we departed from the Riuer of Ahauá on the twelfth day of the first moneth, to go vnto Ierusalém, and the hand of our God was vpon vs, and deliuered vs from the hand of theemie, and of suche as layed ^k waite by the way.

32 And we came to Ierusalém, and abode there three dayes.

33 And on the fourte day was the siluer weighed, and the golde and the vessel in the house of our God by the hand of Meremóth the sonne of Vriáh the Priest, and with him was Eleazár the sonne of Phinehás, and with them was Iozabád the sonne of Ieshúa, and Noadiáh the sonne of Binnúi the ^l Leuites,

34 By number and by weight of euerie one, and all the weight was written at the same time.

35 Also the childre of the captiuitie, which were come out of captiuitie, offred burnt offrings vnto the God of Israël, twelue bullockes for all Israël, ninetie and six rams, seuentie and seven lambes, and twelue he goates for sinne: all was a burnt offering of the Lord.

36 And they deliuered the Kings commif-

sion vnto the Kígs officers, & to the captaines beyonde the Riuer: and they promoted the people, and the house of God.

CHAP. IX.

1 *Ezrá complaineth on the people that had turned them selues from God, and married with the Gentiles. 5 He praieth Vnto God.*

1 **W**HEN as these things were done, ^{3. Esdr. 9. 69.} rulers came to me, saying, The people of Israël, and the Priests and the Leuites are not ^a separated from the people of the lands (as touching their abominacions) to wit, of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Iebusites, the Ammonites, the Moabites, the Egyptians, and the Amorites.

2 For they haue taken their daughters to them selues, and to their sonnes, and they haue mixed the holy sede with the people of the lands, and the hád of the ^b princes & rulers hathe bene chief in this trespassse.

3 But when I heard this saying, I rent my clothes and my garment, and pluckt of the heere of mine head, and of my beard, & sate downe ^c astonied.

4 And there assembled vnto me all that feared the wordes of the God of Israël, because of the transgression of them of the captiuitie. And I sate downe astonied vntil the ^e euening sacrifice.

5 And at the euening sacrifice I arose vp from mine heuines, & when I had rent my clothes and my garment, I fel vpon my knees, and spred out mine hands vnto the Lord my God,

6 And said, O my God, I am cōfounded & ashamed, to lift vp mine eyes vnto thee my God: for our iniquities are increased ouer ^d our head, & our trespassse is growen vp vnto ^e the heauen.

7 From the dayes of our fathers haue we bene in a great trespassse vnto this day, & for our iniquities haue we, our Kings, and our Priests bene deliuered into the hand of ^f Kings of the lands, vnto the sworde, into captiuitie, into a spoyle, and into cōfusion of face, as appeareth this day.

8 And now for a litle space grace hathe bene shewed from the Lord our God, in causing a remnant to escape, & in giuing vs a ^g nayle in his holy place, that our God may light our eyes, & giue vs a litle reuiuing in our seruitude.

9 For though we were bōdemen, yet our God hathe not forsaken vs in our bondage, but hathe enclined mercie vnto vs in the sight of the Kings of Persia, to giue vs life, and to erect the house of our God, and to redresse the desolate places thereof, and to giue vs a wall in Iudáh and in Ierusalém.

10 And now, our God, what shal we say after this? for we haue forsaken thy commandments.

^a From the time they came home vnder Zerubbabél vntil ^h commig of Ezrá, they had degenerate contrary to the Lawe of God, and married where it was not lawfull, Deu. 7.3.

^b That is, the gouerners are the chief beginners hereof.

^c As one doubting whether God wolde continue his benefites toward vs or els destroy this which he had begone. Exod. 32. 33. num. 23. 3.

^d That is, we are drowned in sinne. ^e They so excede that they can not growe greater.

^f In giuing vs a restig place. it is a similitude take of the that remaine still in a place, which smite nailes to hang things vpon. Isa. 22. 24.